

appears to be applying a similar institutional succession playbook. Today, Bajaj Finance has four Deputy CEOs – Manish Jain (also President-B2B & FD business), Sidhant Dadwal (also President-B2C & SME business), Harjeet Toor (President-Bharat Lending, MFI and Strategic Partnerships), and Manish Jain (also MD of Bajaj Financial Securities Ltd).

“Grooming and developing leadership talent and building a bench strength of leaders has always been an important area for us,” says Rajeev Jain. In fact, 90% of the top leaders at the NBFC have been with the company or the group for more than 10 years. As these leaders grow through various roles, their business and leadership mettle gets tested and refined.

The focus is on internal succession but the choice of Jain’s successor from the four Deputy CEOs remains open.

BUSINESS MODEL CHANGE

The road ahead is mired with challenges. The new CEO will have to carry forward the AI agenda, where the company is already taking giant steps. “AI is not just a technology upgrade for us. It is a foundational capability we are weaving into our operating model,” says Jain. He adds that over the next three–five years, four factors will turn the company’s AI stack into a sustainable competitive moat—a business philosophy that embraces AI at scale; deep, proprietary data intelligence built over time; AI-native architecture with teams designed for scale; and strategic use of small language models in areas such as risk, fraud, collections, and customer service.

“We have invested in a dedicated 300-member AI organisation, structured across domains—voice, text, vision, agentic,

GROWTH WITH TECH

After Rajeev Jain, leadership continuity and potential senior exits remain a key uncertainty

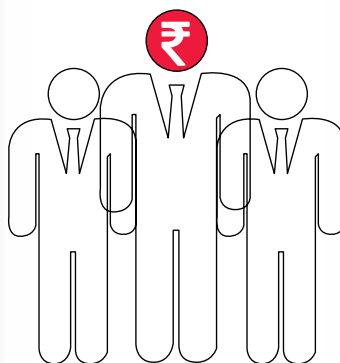
As an NBFC, Bajaj Finance faces a structural funding disadvantage versus banks with CASA

New businesses like green financing, high-value mortgages and CV loans carry higher execution and credit risks

Bank-like regulations for large NBFCs are raising compliance intensity and operating costs

Scaling AI demands rapid upskilling and seamless human–AI collaboration

With a ₹3.67 lakh crore balance sheet, sustaining 20%-plus AUM growth without asset quality dilution will become challenging



data, and tech,” says Jain.

In fact, the lender has already completed a year of implementing its FinAI transformation. It has identified 123 high-impact areas across businesses and functions. The project is well beyond the pilot stage. “AI is embedded across every process—from sales and underwriting to service and collections—and we are seeing scaled outcomes across the organisation,” says Jain.

The company expects over ₹5,000 crore disbursements through conversational AI bots in FY26. At the enterprise level, starting Q3FY26, the Data for AI initiative is unlocking structural value. It has converted over 20 million voice interactions into text for all customer interactions. The company estimates that the initiative will enable ₹500 crore-plus annual disbursements by FY26. “This is a foundational shift that strengthens underwriting quality, cuts turnaround time, and meaningfully lowers manual dependency in documentation-heavy lending segments,” says Jain.

“Our Agentic AI POD reflects the future of service and operations. The operating model of the future will be agent-led, with human-in-the-loop, improving consistency and enhancing productivity,” he says.

The company also has a board-approved AI governance framework in place.

The benefits of the company’s AI implementation are already visible. “We’re seeing impact across costs, productivity, and customer experience today—and as we scale these capabilities across the company, the impact will be sustainable and exponential,” says Jain.